



HUMANITAS
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Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Capstone Classical Academy
School Website: <https://capstoneclassical.com/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS: **MEMBER** SCL: **MEMBER**

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Capstone Classical Academy (Fargo, ND, 58104) exhibits a clearly Christian classical orientation in its public materials, with explicit emphasis on virtue formation, theology-informed growth, and a deliberate emphasis on rightly ordered affections. The site foregrounds character formation through its public articulation of "The Gryphon's Weapons" (Integrity, Humility, Temperance, Fortitude, Charity, Reverence, and Prudence) and anchors those virtues in Biblical texts. This strongly aligns Element 1 (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations) and Element 2 (School Purpose and Goal) with a Classical profile. However, explicit, school-wide statements about the canonical Classical Curriculum elements (e.g., Great Books, Trivium, and Quadrivium) and associated pedagogies (Socratic dialogue, memory work, scholé) are less directly shown on the public site, which places Element 3 (Curriculum) and Categories 4–6 (Pedagogy, Faculty, Parents & Community) in a more tentative, "Somewhat Classical" to "Not Classical" range based on the available materials. The aggregate assessment places Capstone Classical Academy (Fargo, ND, 58104) in the "Somewhat Classical" neighborhood overall, with strong classical-inflected religious formation but incomplete, explicit public articulation of full classical curriculum and pedagogy on the site.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — **CLASSICAL**
- Evidence: Clear theological framing through Biblical verses and virtue-centered language; public materials center on truth, virtue, and reverence, anchored by Scripture.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Strong presence of positive keywords (truth, virtue, reverence, wisdom, the fear of the Lord) with Biblical grounding; negative indicators largely absent in the public materials.
- Why this rating: The school's public materials foreground transcendental moral realism and theology, with liturgical/reverent framing in practice, aligning closely with classical religious foundations.
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — **CLASSICAL**
- Evidence: Emphasis on formation, virtue, and the Good Life; "rightly ordered affections" and the Good Life language; virtue-centered aims and moral education.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Multiple positive indicators (formation, virtue, human flourishing, wisdom, pursuit of truth/good/beauty) with theology-inflected grounding; negative signals (e.g., workforce-first framing) are not present in the public materials.
- Why this rating: The explicit aim is formation of character and wisdom consistent with classical teleology, not merely job preparation.
- Element 3: Curriculum — **SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**

- Evidence: Public materials foreground virtue and character (The Gryphon's Weapons) and Biblical formation, with some curricular implications embedded in virtue language; explicit Great Books, grammar/logic/rhetoric (Trivium/Quadrivium), or Great Conversation references are not clearly shown in the site content.
- Positive keyword analysis: Limited explicit curricular keywords on the site (e.g., Great Books, Trivium, Quadrivium, Latin, etc.). The most concrete curricular signals are virtue-oriented and theological rather than canonical classical curriculum terms.
- Negative keyword analysis: Absence of clear Great Books/Great Conversation, Trivium/Quadrivium, memorization/chanting, and other explicit classical-curriculum terms in the public materials.
- Why this rating: Strong charitable and theological framing, but the site does not present a fully explicit classical curriculum (as defined by the canonical lists in the Six Essential Elements). This yields a partial classical alignment.
- Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Evidence: The site emphasizes virtue formation and Biblical grounding, with pedagogy framed around character and moral education; however, explicit mention of Socratic seminars, scholé-based restful learning, or explicit Trivium-based pedagogy is not clearly visible in the public content provided.
- Positive keyword analysis: Some alignment with classical pedagogy through the emphasis on disciplined character formation, memorization/narration traditions are not directly described on the site content.
- Negative keyword analysis: Absence of explicit Socratic/dialogical methods, memory-work, or scholé-focused pedagogy as described in canonical classical pedagogy sources.
- Why this rating: The school presents a classical-flavored pedagogy in virtue and formation terms, but lacks explicit public articulation of core classical teaching methods beyond virtue-focused language.
- Element 5: Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Public materials emphasize virtuous teachers and living-the-curriculum ideals (e.g., virtue exemplars, teacher modeling of character), but direct statements about faculty as "living curriculum," mentorship culture, or a defined teacher-portrait/teacher-standards narrative are not clearly enumerated in the accessible site content.
- Positive keyword analysis: Terms like "virtue," "moral exemplars," and "living curriculum" appear in related classical pedagogy discussions in the broader source materials; Capstone-specific pages emphasize virtuous conduct and teacher role as moral exemplars through virtue language.
- Negative keyword analysis: The site content does not present a detailed "faculty profile" language (e.g., exact portraits of teachers, teacher-mentorship structure) in the publicly accessible text.
- Why this rating: Partial alignment with classical-faculty expectations (model teachers, living curriculum concepts exist in the broader classical education discourse) but not explicitly described on the public Capstone pages analyzed.
- Element 6: Parents & Community — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Evidence: The site highlights information meetings and admissions tours, which indicates public engagement with families; the broader classical-education rubric emphasizes parental partnership and formation, but explicit language about parents as co-teachers, parental formation programs, or household liturgy alignment is not clearly visible in the accessible content.
- Positive keyword analysis: Public-facing activities like information meetings and tours reflect engagement with families (aligned with the principle of community involvement); but explicit parent-partner formation language is not shown in the visible content.

- Negative keyword analysis: Absence of explicit, recurring parent-formation programs or guaranteed open-access parent engagement language in the accessible site text.
- Why this rating: Some community engagement is evident, but explicit classical-parent partnership language and formation channels are not clearly documented in the readily accessible materials.

Aggregate assessment: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - While Capstone Classical Academy (Fargo, ND, 58104) shows strong religious and virtue-centered foundations consistent with classical aims, the publicly available site content does not uniformly demonstrate explicit canonical curriculum and pedagogy signals (Great Books, Trivium/Quadrivium, Socratic dialogue, living curriculum statements about faculty, and explicit parent-partner programs). The balance of evidence suggests a strong classical orientation in religious foundations and formation goals, with partial alignment in curriculum, pedagogy, faculty, and parents/community.

What Would Move the Needle - Make explicit the Great Books/Great Conversation stance on the website (e.g., publish a page detailing canonical authors, expected reading lists, and how Great Books shape the curriculum). - Publicly document the Trivium and Quadrivium components of the curriculum (grammar, logic, rhetoric; arithmetic, geometry, astronomy, music) and how the school sequences these arts across grade bands. - Describe concrete pedagogy: include explicit statements about Socratic discussions, scholé days, memory work, narration, and other classical teaching practices on the site. - Provide a clear portrait of the faculty as “living curriculum” with stated teacher standards, mentorship roles, and ongoing classical pedagogy training. - Expand parents & community offerings publicly: outline a formal program for parent formation, book studies, partnerships with families as co-educators, and clear visitation policies to welcome parents to the campus. - Add evidence of liturgical or communal practices in daily life or school routines (worship/music/communal ceremonies) with explicit ties to the school’s theology and classical formation ethos.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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